

Small decisions. Useful habits.

Three 45-minute sessions that help learners question an AI answer, pause before a suspicious request and make a money plan that can survive a surprise.

Ages 15+

Groups of 2-4

Paper or browser

No accounts needed

Set the room up for learning

Use fictional people, prices and messages. Nobody needs to reveal their household income, debts, passwords or experiences of fraud. A learner can pass on a question or work alone without explaining why.

Bring

- A copy of the learner sheets for each pair.
- Pens, a calculator and a visible timer.
- An optional shared screen for the site's games.
- Answer pages kept separate until discussion.

Agree together

- Explain the decision, not just the answer.
- Challenge claims without mocking people.
- Ask for a pause when something is unclear.
- Keep examples fictional throughout.

What success looks like

SESSION	LEARNER CAN...	EVIDENCE TO LISTEN FOR
Responsible AI	Improve a prompt and check a factual claim.	Names a source or calculation that could establish whether the claim is right.
Digital safety	Recognise pressure and choose a safe next step.	Uses a separate trusted route instead of the contact details in the suspicious message.
Financial resilience	Balance a budget and explain a trade-off.	Distinguishes expenses, savings transfers and available money; revises a plan after a shock.

Make participation easy. Read instructions aloud as well as showing them. Offer large print. Let a partner do the writing. Do not make speed, colour recognition, internet access or confident English a condition of success.

Assessment, if you use it

Give Form A before the first session and Form B after the last, outside the 45-minute lesson times. Allow 12 minutes each. Use the same randomly assigned paper code on both forms. Report group patterns, not public rankings. The forms are classroom checks; their difficulty has not been empirically equated.

Preparation: check that any online examples and links are still relevant. These activities teach general reasoning. Local support routes and product terms vary; introduce appropriate local help without asking learners to share personal circumstances.

An answer is a starting point.

Learners practise asking clearly, sharing less and checking what matters.

45 minutes

AI verification card

Optional: Prompt Laboratory

TIME	ACTIVITY	FACILITATION
0-5	Opening vote	"An answer sounds confident. Is that evidence it is correct?" Ask for one reason behind each vote.
5-12	Demonstrate	Use the fabricated example below. Separate a checkable number from a broad claim and an unsupported reference.
12-24	Prompt repair in pairs	Each pair rewrites the weak prompt. Swap and check task, context, constraints and verification.
24-36	Evidence hunt	Complete the AI verification card for the example. A calculator and the printed maths reference are sufficient.
36-42	Discuss disagreement	Ask: "What would change your mind? Which claim is still unverified?"
42-45	Exit ticket	Write one safe prompt and one check you would perform before using its answer.

Pair task: repair this prompt

"Here is my friend's bank statement and full name. Tell me exactly what they should invest in."

Replace it with a question that uses fictional numbers, has a clear learning goal and does not ask a tool to make a personal financial decision.

Fabricated AI answer for checking

"€1,000 earning 4% interest each year becomes €1,120 after three years with annual compounding. Every low-risk investment will beat inflation. This is proved by the International Money Certainty Report 2026."

Facilitator key

- Annual compounding gives $€1,000 \times 1.04^3 = \text{€1,124.86}$. €1,120 is the simple-interest result.
- The claim about every low-risk investment is too broad. Returns, inflation, fees and taxes matter; a label does not guarantee purchasing power.
- The report title was invented for this exercise. A realistic title is not evidence that a source exists.
- A stronger prompt: "For a fictional learner with €1,000, explain saving, investing and inflation in 180 words. Use a worked 4% annual-compounding example. State assumptions and name facts that need independent checking."

Debrief: a useful prompt can improve an answer, but no prompt guarantees truth. Protecting privacy is a separate job from checking accuracy. Asking the same tool "Are you sure?" is not an independent check.

Make room for a pause.

Learners practise a response they can use when a message creates urgency, fear or excitement.

45 minutes

Scam checklist

Optional: Can You Spot the Scam?

TIME	ACTIVITY	FACILITATION
0-5	Opening question	“Why might a convincing message be more dangerous than a badly written one?” Do not request personal stories.
5-12	Teach the routine	Pause → inspect the request → verify separately → protect and report. A logo or padlock cannot prove trustworthiness.
12-25	Message triage	Pairs annotate the three scenarios on the scam sheet: request, pressure, unknowns and safe next step.
25-35	Role play	One learner reads a scripted message; the other explains how they would verify it. Never send a real message or follow a suspicious link.
35-42	What if someone clicked?	Use the response sequence below. Practise calm, non-blaming language.
42-45	Exit ticket	Write a safe response to “I changed my number; send €80 now.”

Answer key for the message triage

- Parcel request:** the invented fee, deadline and unfamiliar link justify caution. Check the carrier’s known website or app and your order details independently. Do not pay through the message.
- Friend on a new number:** contact the friend using an existing number or another established route. An urgent story and a familiar name do not establish identity.
- School portal notice:** it might be genuine, but the text alone is insufficient. Open the school’s saved portal address and check the notice there. A safe response does not require deciding the message’s origin with certainty.

If someone has already acted

Stop further interaction. If a password was entered, open the real service separately, change that password and any reused copies, and review sessions and recovery settings. Enable a stronger sign-in method. If money or card details were sent, contact the bank or payment service promptly using a known channel. If software was installed or an attachment was run, seek trusted technical help. Keep useful evidence without forwarding active scam links; use the service’s reporting route.

A useful sentence: “This happens to many people. Let’s work out the next step.” For learners under 18, identify a trusted adult or the institution’s safeguarding contact. Do not promise that lost money can always be recovered.

Do not teach spelling mistakes as a reliable detector. Messages can be polished; genuine accounts can be compromised; voice and video can be manipulated.

Give the budget a real job.

Learners make a plan, meet an unexpected cost and explain what changes.

45 minutes

Budget worksheet

Calculator

TIME	ACTIVITY	FACILITATION
0-5	Opening question	"Can a balanced budget still be fragile?" Invite examples involving timing, uncertainty or no spare cash.
5-12	Model the calculation	Income minus spending minus planned transfers = unallocated money. Savings are not a consumption expense, but they do use this month's cash.
12-25	Build the plan	Pairs complete the fictional €1,200 worksheet. Classify items, calculate totals and explain a category that depends on context.
25-35	Introduce a surprise	Reveal the €120 repair. Each pair proposes two feasible responses and selects one.
35-41	Price-change challenge	A €100 basket rises by 5%. Calculate the new cost. Ask what happens if inflation then falls to 2%.
41-45	Exit ticket	Name the margin in the original plan, one response to the surprise and one limitation of the model.

Worked key

- Monthly spending = **€990**. Planned transfers = €150 to an emergency fund + €10 toward an annual bill. Unallocated money = €1,200 – €990 – €160 = **€50**.
- A €120 repair creates a **€70 gap** after using the €50 margin. One response is to reduce leisure from €90 to €40 and subscriptions from €20 to €0 this month. Then revised spending is €920 + €120 = €1,040, transfers stay €160, and no money remains unallocated.
- Another response is to use €70 from an existing emergency balance after using the €50 margin, then make a replenishment plan. If no fund already exists, that option is unavailable. A transfer planned for later is not the same as money already saved.
- The basket becomes **€105**. A further 2% increase makes it **€107.10**. Lower positive inflation means prices rise more slowly, not that the earlier price increase disappears.

Discuss the trade-offs. A necessary cost cannot always be cut. Small discretionary cuts cannot solve every shortfall. Changing payment timing, checking eligibility for support or seeking qualified debt support may matter more. Avoid presenting financial difficulty as a failure of willpower.

Finish with one practical habit

Ask each learner to choose a habit to practise using fictional data: check one claim, verify one unexpected request, or review one budget assumption. Invite a reason; do not require a personal pledge or a disclosure.

Background reading: [NIST, Generative AI Profile](#) (confabulation); [NIST, Phishing](#); [ECB, What is inflation?](#). Links support the concepts; the activities and fictional cases are original teaching material.